Aronda

© 2007 Michail Antonow & Jens-Peter Schliemann

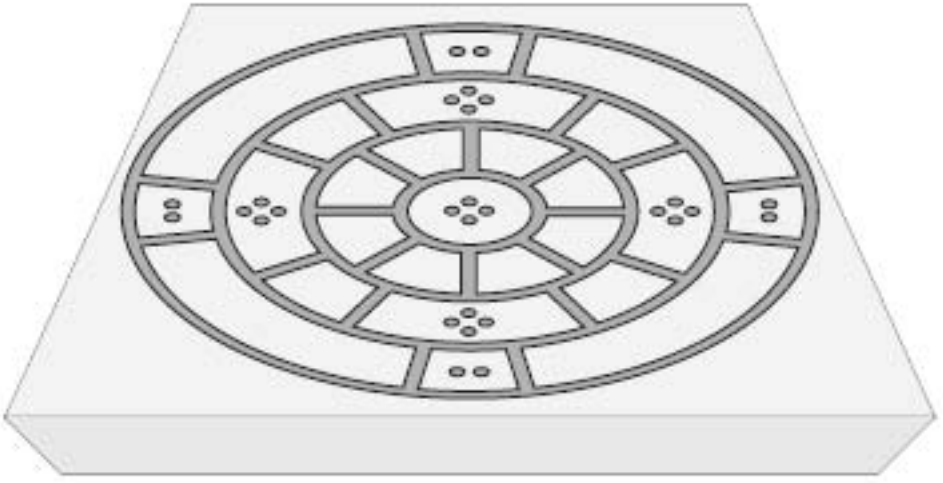
Position and conquer – and watch the chain reaction

Two-player strategy game

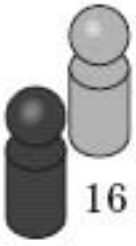
8 years and up

MATERIALS

1 gameboard



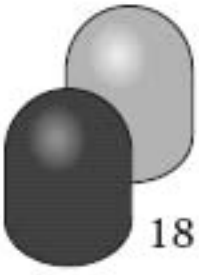
32 placement pieces



16 x red,

16 x black

36 possession pieces



18 x red,

18 x black

OBJECT OF THE GAME

Take possession of more than half of the 25 fields.

SET-UP

Put the gameboard in the middle of the table.

Both players get 16 placement pieces and 18 possession pieces each in their color.

COURSE OF THE GAME

The players alternate turns.

On your turn, place 2 of your placement pieces, either both on one field or each on a different field.

The only exception:
On his first turn, the starting player places only 1 placement piece.

Where can you place pieces?

You may place your placement pieces either on fields in the outer ring, or in fields connected to the outer edge of the board by an uninterrupted chain of fields containing placement pieces or possession pieces of your colour.

Both players may place placement pieces on the same field.

If a player owns a field, no placement pieces can be put there any more.

How do you take fields into your possession?

The gameboard has 2-piece fields (marked with 2 holes),
3-piece fields (unmarked), and
4-piece fields (marked with 4 holes).

As soon as a player has placed
2 placement pieces in a 2-piece field,
3 placement pieces in a 3-piece field, or
4 placement pieces in a 4-piece field,
he takes possession of the field.

To do so, you take all placement pieces – your own and your opponent's – from the field and put them back into the players' stock(s), and place one of your own possession pieces on the field.

Then you check whether, in accordance with your new possession, you can also take neighboring fields into your possession:

As soon as a player owns 2 fields adjacent to a 2-piece field,
3 fields adjacent to a 3-piece field,
4 fields adjacent to a 4-piece field,
and that field is not owned by anybody, he may take it into his possession.

Remove the placement pieces from this field, place your possession piece there, and check for the possible occupation of additional adjacent fields.

END OF THE GAME

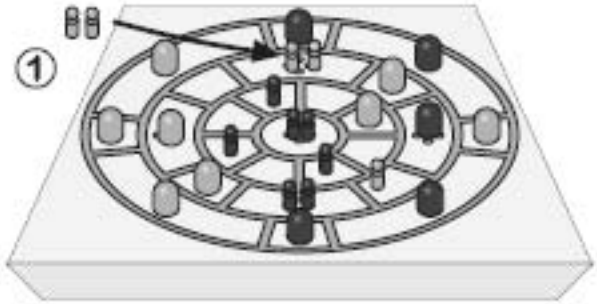
ARONDA ends when all 25 fields are owned by the players.
The player who has the most fields (13 or more) wins.

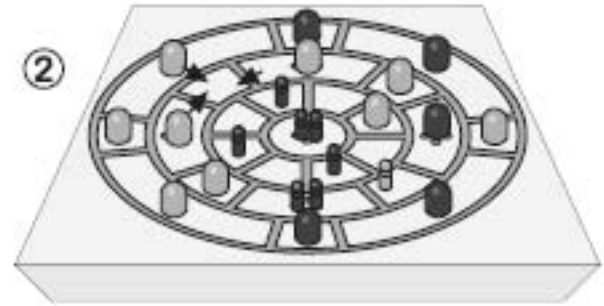
Connecting to the outer ring + Occupying

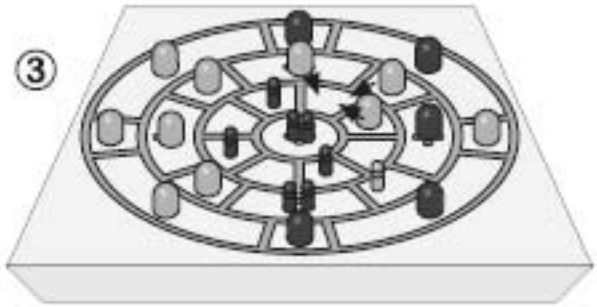
Black may place his next placement piece on any of the "⊗ " fields.
Black decides to place both pieces on one field. In doing so,
he takes the field into his possession and interrupts the red chain.

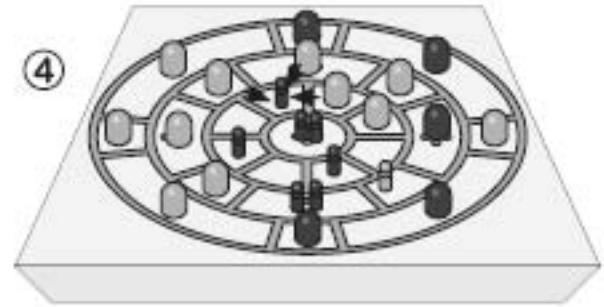
Chain reaction

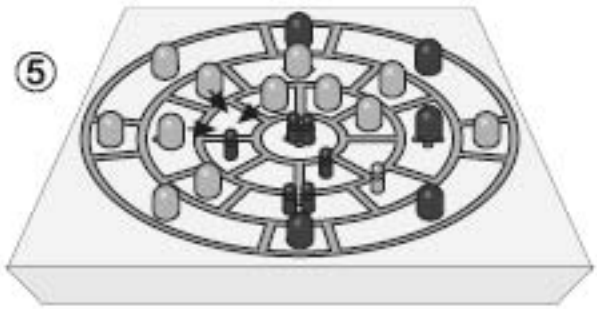
Red makes his placement and takes 8 fields into his possession in one turn.

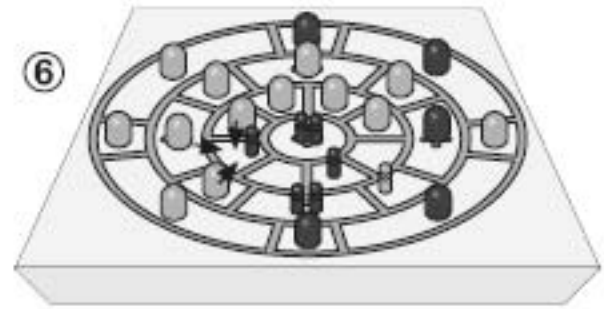












The Development of ARONDA

Michail Antonow had the idea of a "Conquer from Outside" game.
You win a field through a majority of adjacent fields. As for the playing mechanics, the two game inventors got energized by the interesting chain reactions possible through "Conquer from Outside."

They tried out many gameboards with different subdivisions.
By means of mathematical tricks, Jens-Peter Schliemann tried to find as many fields as possible with an uneven adjacent number and an uneven number of fields.

In ARONDA, only the field in the middle has an even number of adjacent fields.
A configuration with an uneven number of fields as well as an uneven number of adjacent fields for each field has been mathematically proved to be impossible!

The game inventors' team

Antonow and Schliemann have been a game inventors' team since 1996.
Together they authored KARIBIK (CARIBBEAN) and ARONDA.
They both like two-player strategy games, such as REVERSI.
They were awarded for their two-player strategy games
CONHEX (Antonow), nominated for the INTERNATIONAL GAMERS AWARD,
and FIRE & ICE (Schliemann), which received the MENSA SELECT.

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Gerhards
Spiel und Design

Not suited for children under 3 years since small parts can be swallowed!

English translation: Sybille & Bruce Whitehill, "Word for Wort"